

("Proving a Point", November 23). China has increasingly become a force that engages in anti-India talk at multilateral meets, goes about a 'string of pearls' strategy to assert regional co-dominance with India, and continues to keep long-standing border disputes simmering. It has become imperative for India to strengthen itself internally through a robust political system, a healthy economy inclusive of the poor, build on infrastructure and bring efficiency at all levels so that it can be less hindered by external influences such as China's. NISHITHA MISHRA, via www.indiatoday.in

Friendly Foes

It is a blessing in disguise that political opportunism between the now-distanced Kalyan Singh and Mulayam Singh Yadav has been exposed, which will badly harm both ("Down on the Mat", November 23). Kalyan as usual has once again become politically unemployed with no sign of anyone willing to provide him political shelter. The Samajwadi Party (SP) is utterly confused on getting votes and has conflicting approaches. It welcomed Kalyan to get Lodh votes but when Muslims went away from the party, the SP broke relations with Kalyan. By undoing the wrong done by distancing from Kalyan, it cannot

bring back Muslim votes for Yadav. Unfortunately, the Indian political system is a victim of the politics of opportunism rather than being driven by ideology. MADHU AGRAWAL, Delhi

Rich House

The entry of people with significant economic clout in Parliament and its committees is indeed a cause of conflict ("Business of

In Search of Peace

A failed state with a skeleton democracy, Pakistan is dependent on US munificence for survival ("Can Pakistan Be Saved?", November 16). When the US troops themselves have failed to rein in the Taliban and the Al Qaeda in Afghanistan, it is doubtful whether Pakistan can ever win a war against well entrenched terrorists.

K.R. NARASIMHAN, Chennai



SHAILESH RAVAL/www.indiatodayimages.com

“Elevated pipelines are more vulnerable to the pilferage of crude and other petroleum products. The authorities need to control the situation soon or it'll get worse.”

GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, via www.indiatoday.in

the Day", November 23). The system must ensure that the particular concern of every member is put on the table and the promotion of individual, as distinct from his constituency's collective interests, is effectively barred. BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

The Conflict Within

Many leaders in Jammu and Kashmir and unscrupulous separatists are on the same track ("Beaten Track", November 16). Not only do they delude the public, but are serving as stooges of Pakistan, as they demand tripartite talks, which is a banality. INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

FEBRUARY 1-15, 1980

The Area of Crisis

Not since the 1962 Cuban crisis has the world edged as close to an international holocaust as it has over the Afghanistan issue. And not since the Bangladesh War nine years later has India found itself in the nucleus of superpower attention. By last week, India had adopted the image of a demure and prospective bride being wooed ardently by the US and Russia for support over the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan. The crisis in Kabul broke wide open while India was going through the pangs of electing a new government. The Indian delegate at the UN was forced to expound India's stand in the General Assembly, before the Indira Gandhi government could be sworn in. And before the debutant foreign minister P.V. Narasimha Rao had time to examine the official files, British foreign secretary Lord Carrington flew in from Pakistan to outline the dangers of the Soviet bear at the Khyber Pass.

by Dilip Bobb, Chhotu Karadia and Inderjit Badhwar in Washington



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